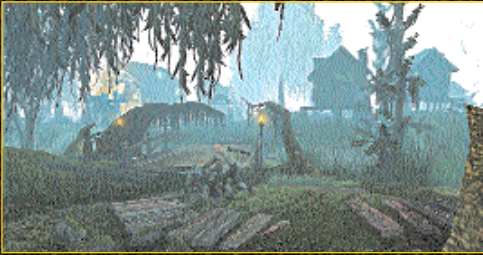


Neverwinter Nights 2

Epic Adventures



The follow-up to NWN—the much-revered “RPG Game of the Year 2002”—Neverwinter Nights 2 (NWN 2) is finally here. NWN went down in the annals of gaming history as the first RPG ever to combine the hardcore D&D rule set into such an involving game. NWN 2 follows suit, with a brand-new graphics engine, an even more epic storyline, and subtle elements interwoven into the gameplay that add to the overall experience.

Like the new playable classes. Besides adding a race to the mix of elves, dwarves, and barbarians, you now have a bunch of new prestige classes, and a new base class *The Warlock*. Character customisation is much more involving than in NWN, and fans will spend a lot of time building characters and customising them.

Without any spoilers, the story plays you as a nondescript resident of a tiny village, West Harbor. You're tasked by your rather stern stepfather with retrieving a magical shard from nearby. Upon successful return you discover the town's been attacked—naturally, the attackers wanted the shard you just acquired. You are

then packed off by “dad” to the city of Neverwinter. Needless to say, adventures abound *en route* and later.

What's really wonderful is the way the story involves you, with storyline missions, sideline missions, and some mini-game-like elements, like playing Lord of your very own keep! That's all the tantalising storyline titbits you'll get from me...

NWN 2 earns a must-play tag even before you consider its excellent visuals. Although not the most splendid-looking RPG title, the graphics are very much up there. Spell and weapon effects are excellent, and so are character model animations. The Aurora 2 engine really delivers!

NWN 2 isn't really taxing graphically, except at maximum detail and high resolutions, at which even the 512 MB on my x1900xt didn't help much. There were just a couple of instances of framing, though, during the countless late-night sessions spent smiting evil and great cleaving! A must-try for any gamer worth his sand.

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Rating:

9/10

Developer:

Atari

Publisher:

Obsidian

System Requirements:

Pentium IV 1.8 GHz or equivalent,
512 MB RAM, Direct X 9 compliant 128
MB graphics card,
Direct X 9 compliant sound card